

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 5 2

♥ 8 6

♦ K 9 5 2

♣ Q J 6

♠ Q 9

♥ A 9 5

♦ A J 6 3

♣ A K 7 4



♠ 6 3

♥ K J 7 4 2

♦ Q 10

♣ 10 9 8 3

♠ K J 10 8 4

♥ Q 10 3

♦ 8 7 4

♣ 5 2

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

1♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥4

dummy and the rest of the ♠s by leading toward the ♥Q.

On these pages there have been many deals where you had to win the opening lead with an unnecessarily high card in order to create a later entry to dummy.

Here's a question: How many times at the table have situations like this presented themselves but you didn't realize it? And of course, at the table there is no second page popping up to tell you what you should have done.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥4, you play low in dummy and West plays the ♥8.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 5

The winners list looks a little skimpy, but what a nice solid ♠ suit. It will be a cinch to establish 4 winners in the suit - if only you have an entry to reach them.

You are probably getting good at this by now. The way to make sure of a dummy entry is to pass up the Cheap Trick ♥9 and win the first trick with the ♥A. Since West did not play third-hand-high he probably doesn't have a high card to play. You are confident that East has led from the ♥K so by taking the ♥A at once you guarantee you can get back to dummy when you need to do so.

After you win the ♥A you start on ♠s, and they hold-up their ♠A for one round. But you can get to

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 10
 ♥ A K 6 2
 ♦ A J 8 6
 ♣ K 3

♠ K 2

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ Q 7 4 2

♣ A 7 5



♠ A 4 3

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 9 5

♣ Q J 10 9 2

♠ 9 8 7 6 5

♥ Q 8

♦ K 10 3

♣ 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	1NT	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠9			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠9, dummy plays the ♠10 and North the ♠K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

I'll bet you got this one. The extra ♣ tricks you need are winnable only if you can get back to your hand after knocking out the ♣A. But the only possible entry card is the ♠A. If you use it on the first trick the Defense will hold up their ♣A for one trick and your hand will be shot..

So let North keep the first trick, (sacrificing one ♠ winner), and take the next ♠ in dummy. Then establish ♣s.

You sacrifice one ♠ trick for four ♣ tricks. A good deal.

Yet another variation on the theme.

There are two basic types; one where you give up a winner to gain an entry, and this type where you get the entry without giving up a thing.

It looks a little different, but the theme is the same. PROTECT YOUR ENTRY.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9
♥ A 10 8 3 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ 8 5 4

♠ Q 5 2

♥ J 5

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ Q 10 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 8 3

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ 10 8

♣ K 7 3

♠ K 7 6 4

♥ K 7

♦ K Q J 3

♣ A J 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥3			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥3, you play dummy's ♥J and East plays the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=4 ♣=1 Total = 6

Unless you want to go down really, really early you had better take your ♥K right now. And unless you want to go down almost as early you'd better stay completely away from the ♠ suit. So that only leaves you the ♣ suit to get 3 more winners in. East will have to have ♣K so you can finesse it. You are also going to have to be smart with entries. Got it?

If East has just ♣ K x then one finesse, followed by the ♣A to drop the ♣K and a small ♣ back to dummy will give you the 4 ♣ winners you must have. But if East has ♣ K x x and refuses to cover then you will be able to establish the ♣s but will need an extra dummy entry to enjoy that last winner.

So win the ♥K and play the ♦ K Q. If both defenders follow suit you can afford to overtake your ♦J with dummy's ♦A. Now play the ♣10 and let it ride. If it holds the trick play another ♣ to your ♣J and then play the ♣A, dropping East's ♣K.

Enter dummy by playing your ♦3 to the ♦6 and take your established ♣ for the ninth trick.

Suppose a defender showed out on the second ♦.

With only one outside entry to dummy your choices are limited.

You might play East for ♣ K x and lead a small to your ♣J, then play ♣A.

Or you might try leading the ♣Q hoping that East will see this as a time to "cover an honor with an honor".

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9 8
♥ 8 5 2
♦ A K 6 2
♣ K 9

♠ 6 4
♥ 9 7 6 4
♦ Q 9 5
♣ Q 10 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 7
♥ K 3
♦ 8 7 4 3
♣ A J 6 5

♠ K 5 3 2
♥ A Q J 10
♦ J 10
♣ 7 3 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♣4			

West is to play 3NT. North leads the ♣4, you play dummy's ♣5 and South plays the ♣7.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 6

You'd really like to find 3 winners without broaching that ♥ suit, so you decide to pin your hopes on the ♠ finesse. But you have a problem. When you win the first trick with the ♣9 your only safe entry to dummy is by leading your ♣K to the ♣A. And this uses up one of your ♣ winners! Do you see a way to avoid the problem?

Don't win the first trick with the ♣9, win with the ♣K.

North plays low.

at trick two you enter dummy by playing your ♣9 and finessing the ♣J! You are pretty sure North has led from the ♣Q so you expect this to work.

South plays low.

Lead the ♠10 (or ♠Q) and underplay it with your ♠8 (or ♠9), so you stay in dummy. You had better cash the ♣A next, then the ♠Q, letting it ride if not covered. Finally, one last ♠ finesse gives you 4 ♠ winners.

This is another twist on the them of winning with a higher card than necessary.

Here it doesn't actually create an extra entry, it just preserves the one entry you have but saves you an actual trick.

Here is an interesting point. Suppose that North's opening lead had been a ♥ and South had taken the first four ♥ tricks then played a ♦. You would have played the hand the same way! Take the ♣K, then finesse the ♣J.